

26NWCV01856 26NWCV01856

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: L

Hearing date: 2026-08-11

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Case Number: 26NWCV01856 Hearing Date: August 11, 2026 Dept: L

I.

Defendant Mitsubishi Motors North

America, Inc.'s Application for Admission Pro Hac Vice of Rachel A. Sternlieb is GRANTED.

II.

Defendant Mitsubishi Motors North

America, Inc.'s Application for Admission Pro Hac Vice of Brandon L. Bigelow is GRANTED.

Defendant to give notice.

Background

This is an action for breach of contract. Defendant Mitsubishi Motors North America, Inc. ("MMNA") now applies for admission pro hac vice of Rachel A. Sternlieb and Brandon L. Bigelow.

No oppositions have been filed as of August 10, 2026.

Legal Standard

California Rules of Court Rule

9.40 provides that an attorney in good standing in another jurisdiction may apply to appear pro hac vice in this State by way of written application with proof of service by mail and notice of hearing on the application to all parties who have appeared in the case and on the State Bar of California at its

San Francisco office, so long as that attorney is not a resident of California, does not work in California, and does not perform regular or substantial business, professional, or other activities in the State. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 9.40(a), (c)(1).) The State Bar of California may set an appropriate application fee to be paid by counsel pro hac vice. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 9.40(e).)

The written application must provide the following information: (1) applicant attorney's residence and office addresses; (2) the courts to which the applicant attorney has been admitted and dates of admission; (3) representation that the attorney applicant is a member in good standing in the courts of admission; (4) representation that the attorney is not currently suspended or disbarred in any court; (5) the title of each court and action in which the applicant attorney has appeared pro hac vice in this State in the preceding two years, if any; and (6) the name, address, and telephone number of the active California State Bar member who is counsel of record in the local action. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 9.40(d).)

Discussion

MMNA now applies for pro hac vice admission of Attorneys Rachel A. Sternlieb and Brandon L. Bigelow, both partners at Defense counsel's firm, Nelson Mullins Riley & Scarborough LLP.

Defense counsel has submitted the pro hac vice applications to the State Bar of California and paid the necessary \$600.00 fee. (Hanna Decls., ¶ 8, Exh. A.) Plaintiff was served the Notices of Hearing and Verified Applications. (See POS.)

Rachel A. Sternlieb

Attorney Rachel A. Sternlieb is a member in good standing of the State Bars of Colorado, Louisiana, and Wyoming. (Sternlieb App., ¶ 3.) Attorney Sternlieb is not currently suspended or disbarred in any court. (Id. at ¶ 4.) Attorney Sternlieb does not reside, practice, or perform substantial activities in California. (Id. at ¶ 2.) Attorney Sternlieb resides at 6531 S. Ogden St., Denver, CO 80209. (Id. at ¶ 1.) Attorney Pascale's office address is 1400 Wewatta Street, Suite 500, Denver, Colorado 80202. (Ibid.) Attorney Sternlieb has submitted one other application to appear pro hac vice in California (United States District

Court, Central District of California) in the past two years, which was granted. (Id. at ¶ 5.) The counsel of record in the local action is designated as: Monee Takla Hanna of Nelson Mullins Riley & Scarborough LLP, 19191 S. Vermont Ave., Ste. 900, Torrance, California 90502, Telephone Number (424) 221-7400. (Id. at ¶ 6.)

Brandon L. Bigelow

Attorney Brandon L. Bigelow is a member in good standing of the State Bar of Commonwealth of Massachusetts. (Bigelow App., ¶ 3.) Attorney Bigelow is not currently suspended or disbarred in any court. (Id. at ¶ 4.) Attorney Bigelow does not reside, practice, or perform substantial activities in California. (Id. at ¶ 2.) Attorney Bigelow resides at 759 Dale St., North Andover, MA 01845. (Id. at ¶ 1.) Attorney Bigelow 's office address is One Financial Center, Suite 3500, Boston, Massachusetts 02111. (Ibid.) Attorney Bigelow has submitted one other application to appear pro hac vice in California (United States District Court, Central District of California) in the past two years, which was granted. (Id. at ¶ 5.) The counsel of record in the local action is designated as: Monee Takla Hanna of Nelson Mullins Riley & Scarborough LLP, 19191 S. Vermont Ave., Ste. 900, Torrance, California 90502, Telephone Number (424) 221-7400. (Id. at ¶ 6.)

Conclusion

The Court finds that Attorneys Rachel A. Sternlieb and Brandon L. Bigelow have complied with all pro hac vice application requirements.

Accordingly, MMNA's Applications for Admission Pro Hac Vice of Rachel A. Sternlieb and Brandon L. Bigelow are granted.